Brief FPA33502: Evaluation and Refinement

By

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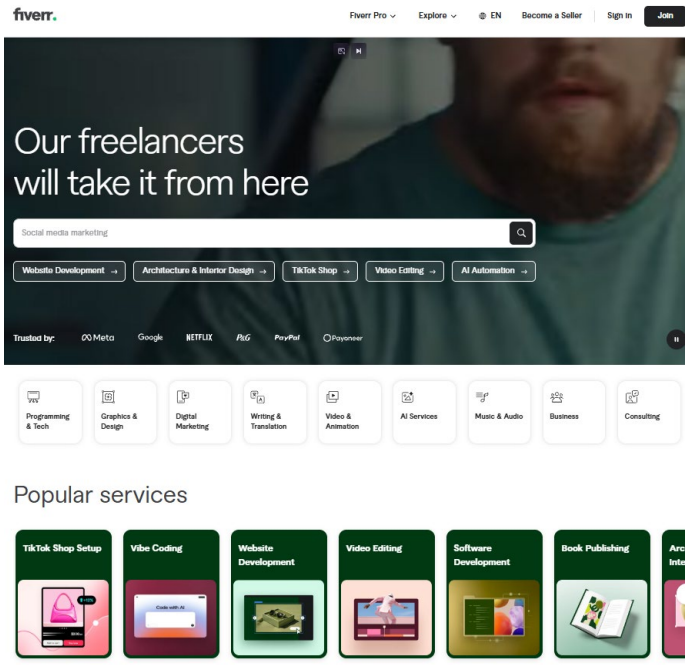
AI Declaration

Phase 1

Competitor Analysis

Competitor 1: Fiverr

Fiverr is an online freelance marketplace where businesses and individuals can market and sell their digital services or purchase other people's digital services (Fiverr, 2024). Relating to the work from this brief's previous phase, where the idea was a freelance hub where people can interact with freelancers, the main difference between Fiverr and my idea is that Fiverr hosts individuals' portfolios, while the proposed idea is more about getting into contact with the individuals not for work but as a means to learn. Fiverr, at its core, is a website that allows both experts and freelancers to offer their skills for purchase and earn income. It acts more like a store where you can search through categorised specialisations. It also markets its own courses about starting small businesses (Fiverr, 2024).



From a visual standpoint, the design is sleek, with the two main colours being green and white, and they stick to that. The white helps the individuals' thumbnails stand out without creating a visual mess, making it more practical. The navigation through the website is clean, with spaced headings and links at the top, and an extensive hamburger menu you can drop down to sift through all the specialisations with ease. It also hosts many videos on its homepage, which helps with user retention and lends the website a sense of polish.

The main practical takeaway from Fiverr that I can incorporate into my design is a polished homepage; currently, my homepage lacks visual appeal and a sense of what the website is

meant to be. Including more information on the homepage can make the overall navigation experience and the website's functionality easier to grasp.

The visual takeaway would be the simple use of colours. As stated before, with the white complementing the individual's ability to display their work on Fiverr, it can be translated into the proposed solution because it will also have the ability for users to share their portfolios, so incorporating the simpler colour scheme allows for a better visual experience



Competitor 2: Upwork

Upwork is a business-focused approach to gig work. It allows individuals to price their own work to anyone across the globe (Brown, 2024). It also hosts a detailed profile section where individuals can discuss their specialisations, along with reviews from people who have hired them before. This is great from a hiring perspective because of the transparency it provides. When signing up for Upwork, the process walks you through creating a simple profile, then makes you post a job request while you fill out your profile. This is a good feature that my current solution lacks: an easy-to-use onboarding process. A visual feature present in Upwork that I can incorporate into my own work is the tags. The tags on profiles allow people to view a very quick description of an individual's specialities, enabling quick understanding and decision-making.

Visually, Upwork has a very good visual hierarchy, with its profile layouts being compact and providing a lot of information without being overbearing, as well as the skill tags mentioned before. From an aesthetic standpoint, it also uses colours sparingly, with the majority in black and white; like Fiverr, this allows the website to look sleek and professional, which is what it wants for its mood and feel. In their profiles, individuals can post previous work, much like a portfolio. The visual navigation is also to note, with clearly worded sections that allow for quick movement to get to where you want within the website; it even has a search feature if you are looking for something hyper-specific.

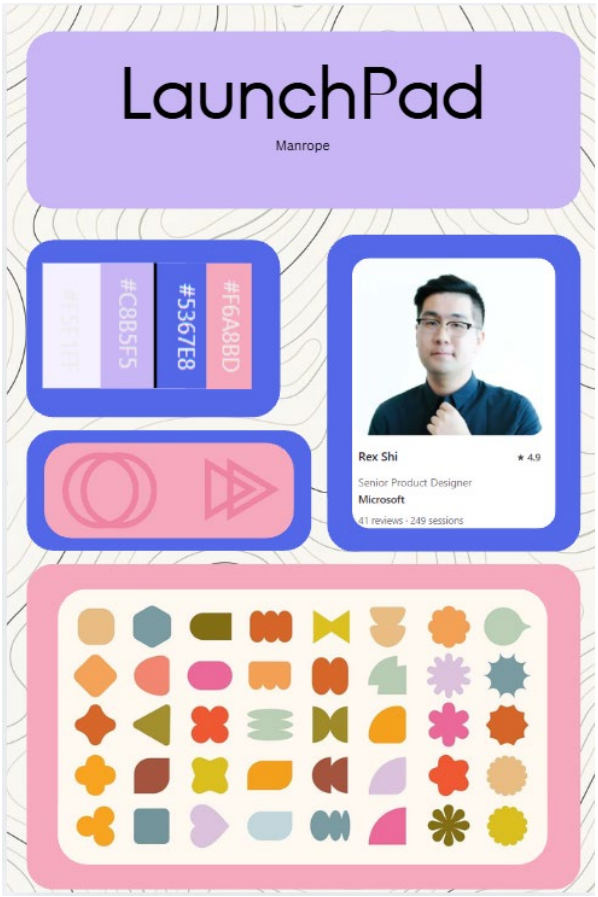
The key takeaway from Upwork for my own project is to include a better navigation system and make the profile section more detailed, so the website can match graduates with mentors who share their skill tags to get the best possible matches.

Competitor 3: ADPList

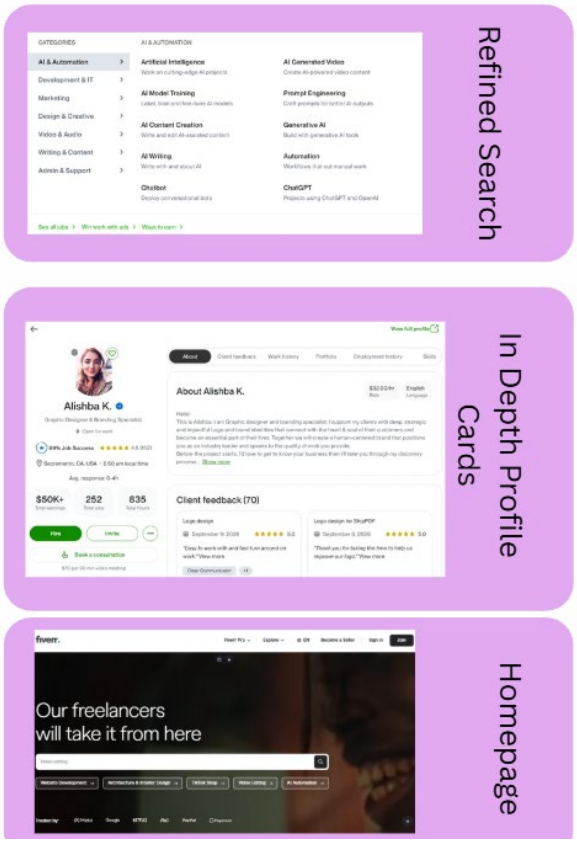
Compared to the last two competitors, ADPList is a mentorship-focused website that allows individuals to seek online mentoring for career experience from people who have worked in those careers. ADPList has profile cards for its mentors so users can compare before selecting, and a filtering option to find exactly what they are looking for. This suggests that graduates should be able to search for mentors by skill tags and filter the results to match what they are looking for. Career development, in general, is an intimidating process, and ADPList allows individuals to browse the Help section to determine, based on their own needs, what they want to pursue. ADPList has broad connections with many professionals across multiple careers and with a professional community that supports its ideal. Visually the pattern of havinf a simple white background with not a lot of colours is present with hints of colours only being strategically placed in areas where there needs attention drawn.

Visual Analysis

Mood board



Inspo Board



Brand Identity

Logo

LaunchPad

Colour Scheme

#ffffff

#C8B5F5

#5367E8

#F6A8BD

Headings

Manrope

Bold Regular Thin

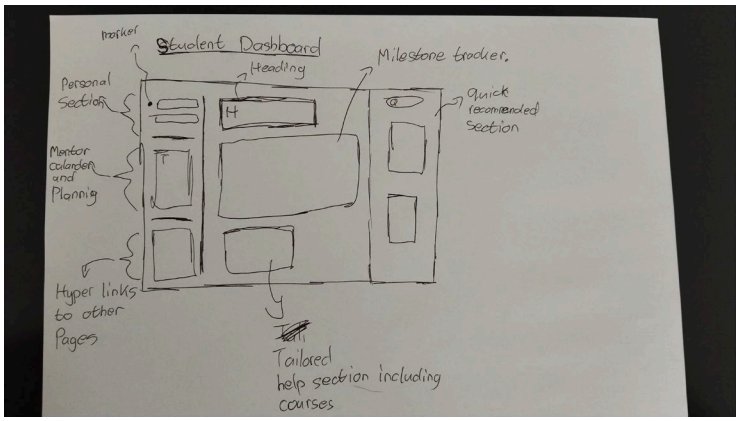
Body

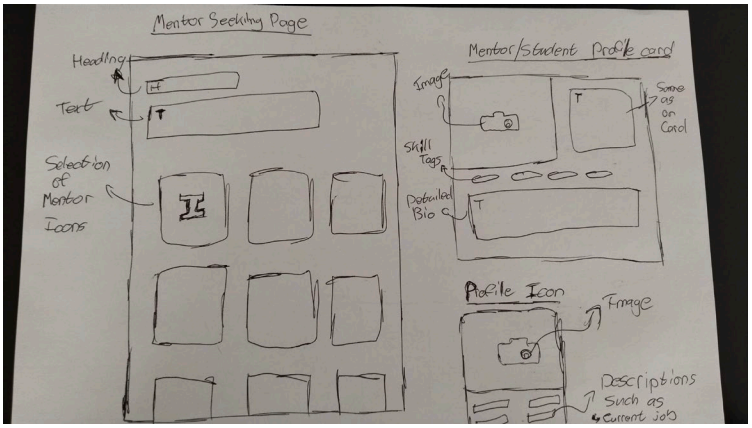
Inter

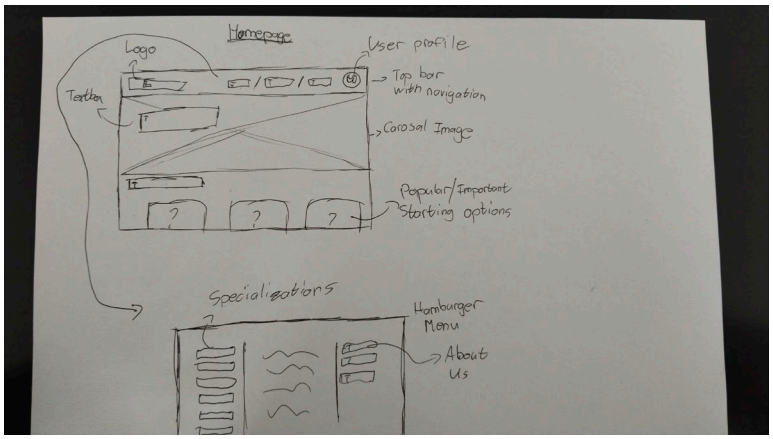
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Phase 2

Low Fidelity Sketch (Annotated)

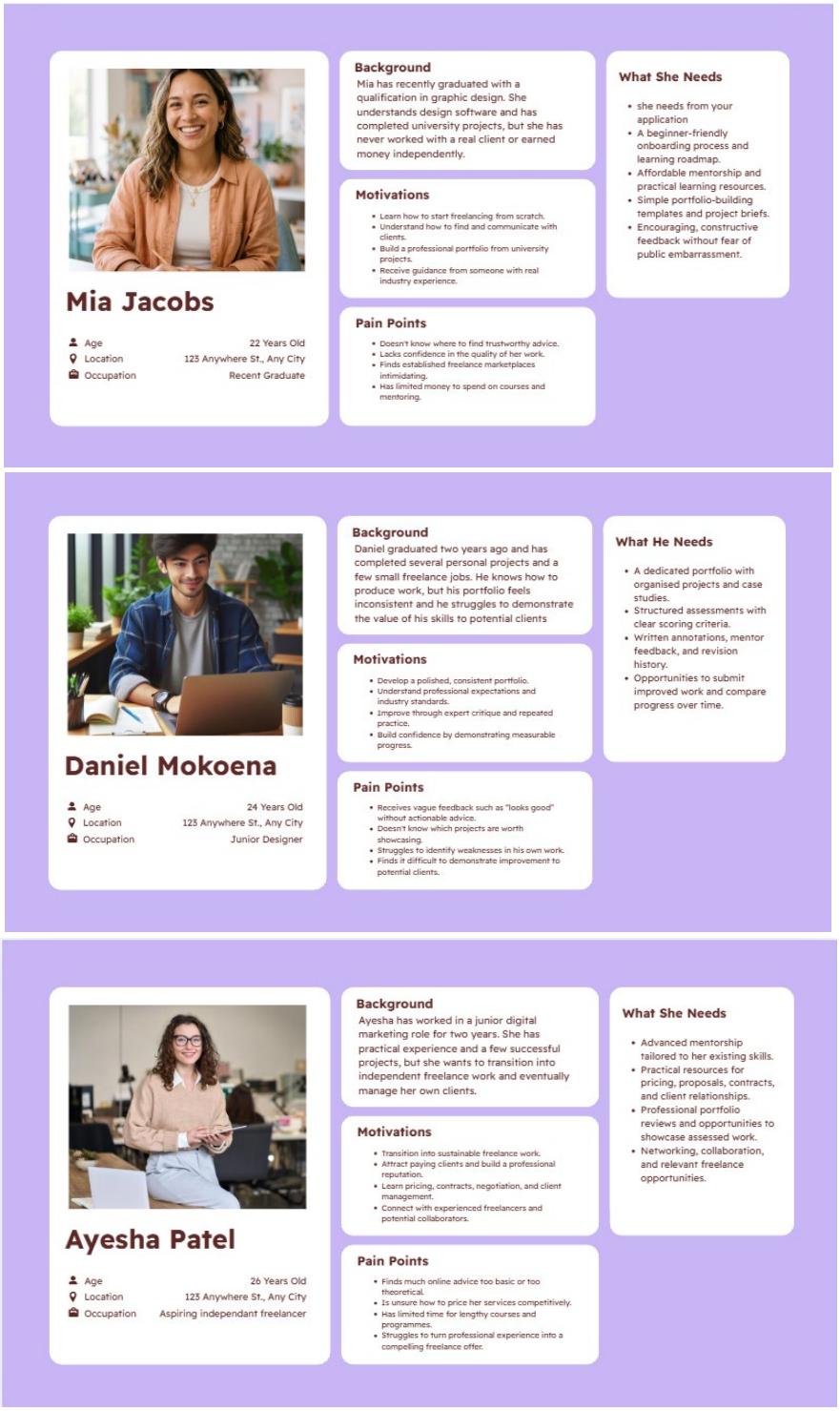




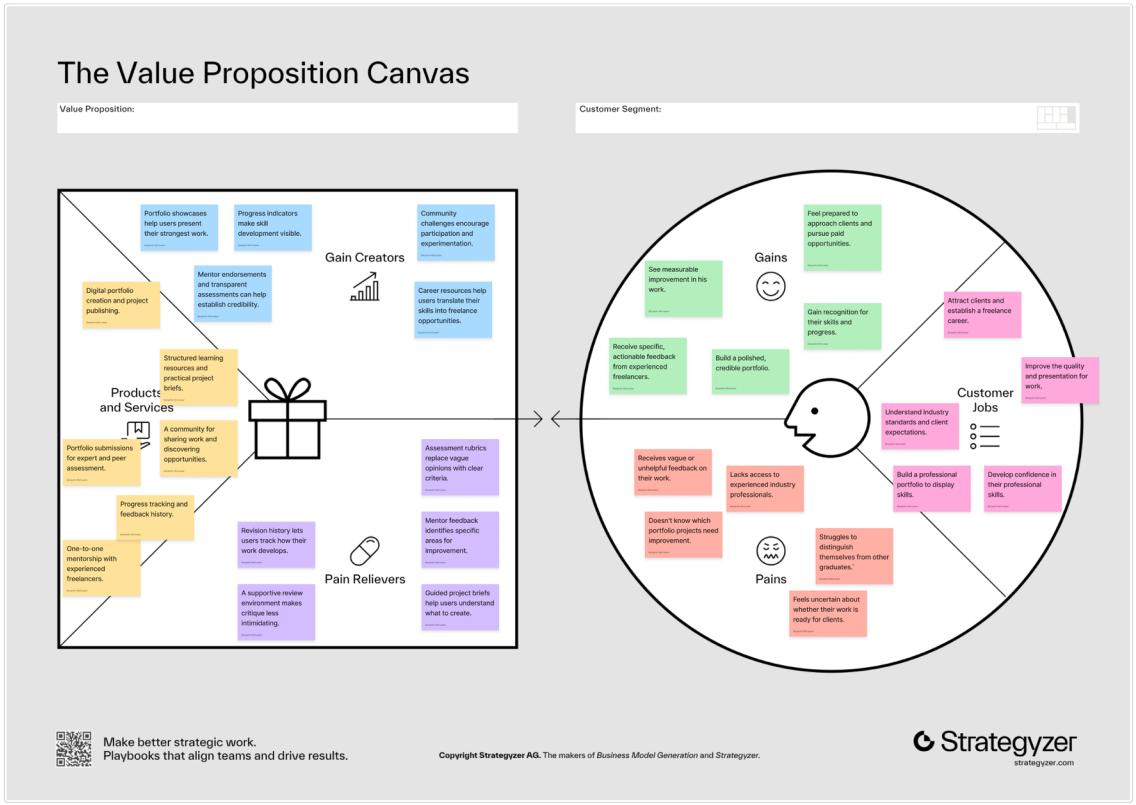


Phase 3

Personas



Value Proposition Canvas



App development

Moving forward with this project would require either using raw coding tools to create a visual, interactive webpage that hosts a physical, interactive prototype to share, or using third-party website builders such as Wix.

WiX

Wix is a website builder that removes all the background coding work that would normally be required to create a website and allows for the management of the website after it is made (Wix, 2019). While Wix has great features, such as thousands of templates and ease of use, access to get the most out of it requires a subscription, with multiple features locked behind it.

Framer

Framer is a more modern tool for creating visually polished websites, with great tools for animations, transitions, and interactive elements (Framer - A lightning-fast interactive design tool, 2019). It does advanced content; however, management can cause issues when pursuing larger projects.

Coding

Raw coding allows full control over the layout and design without being forced to pay for subscription plans or locked out of features. It also enables the building of complex systems if need be and proper prototyping of features. Coding, however, takes much longer than website builder platforms and can often be frustrating to use. It also requires more coding knowledge to achieve results similar to those you can get with a website builder.

Choice	Positive	Negative
Wix	Easy to use	Subscription service for full access
Framer	Can create polished websites	Complex management systems to get lost in when pursuing larger projects
Coding	Full creative control and freedom	Much higher knowledge required

For this brief, the goal is to have a polished website that can be shown as either a prototype or an MVP, so, from the three options, the choice for developing the website is Framer.

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